OMNIA VANITAS STUDIOS

LIKENESS : THE GAME

OVS PRODUCTION BIBLE AND AGENT-READY DEVELOPMENT PIPELINE

V001 - June 12, 2026

A complete start-to-finish production system for building the Unreal game, reusable asset/reference pipeline, interactive Three.js web companion, and agent-ready development handoff.

LOCKED LAW

> **Face is the budget. Room is the antagonist. Camera is a witness. The image must feel playable.**

01 / Executive Build Map

This document converts the LIKENESS universe into a controlled production pipeline. The goal is not to generate random assets. The goal is to build a repeatable game-and-web system where story, visuals, characters, mechanics, and prompts can expand without losing identity.

Layer	Primary Tool	Purpose	Output
Story System	Markdown + CSV / JSON	Define beats, objects, room states, doubles, evidence timeline	Narrative registries
Reference System	AI image generation + OVS QC	Ideation, clean sheets, isolated parts, orthographic views	Model-ready reference packs
Asset Lab	Blender + MCP + 3D AI providers	Clean, bake, shade, rig, assemble, export	GLB/FBX/PBR assets
Main Game	Unreal Engine 5.7	Playable Room 14 vertical slice	UE project and build
Web Companion	React/Vite/Three.js	Interactive motel map, tapes, evidence, character cards	Browser experience
Agent Handoff	Claude Code / Codex / Fable-style prompt	Milestone-based implementation with guardrails	Repo-ready task system

- Build the vertical slice first: Room 14, hallway, inspect system, mirror lag, tape contradiction, one double, and one end card.

- Treat every character and prop as a registry item with an ID, status, dependency list, and QC notes.

- Use 3D AI only after the 4-step reference workflow passes: Ideation, Clean Sheet, Parts, Views.

- Keep Unreal and Three.js connected through shared data, matching asset IDs, and matching visual rules.

02 / Source-of-Truth Context

LIKENESS is a psychological chamber universe centered on The Dellwood motel, Room 14, doubles, memory contradiction, romance under suspicion, and the line: the room remembers what love edits out.

Source Element	Locked Use
OVS Production Bible V.002 language	Cream paper, near-black text, muted olive metadata, thin rules, editorial hierarchy, dense but controlled production structure.
LIKENESS film DNA	Room 14, THOREAU, DRYA, dark doubles, mirror lag, tapes, hallway, motel office, key 14, locket, black device.
LIKENESS : THE GAME memory	AAA-leaning UE5 psychological horror, P.T. meets Control, playable cinematic capture, MetaHuman-level fidelity, no concept-art capture cheating.
Interactive site / game map	Open motel multiverse with hidden films, episodes, games, fashion, music, art, and easter eggs.
Agent workflow preference	GOAL / STYLE / OUTPUT / CONSTRAINTS / PIPELINE / FORMAT; clean handoff docs for Codex and Claude Code.

03 / Creative North Star

LIKENESS : THE GAME is a controlled psychological romantic horror game where a motel room behaves like a memory editor. The player explores, inspects, compares, and chooses while the room changes around them.

The first game should not sprawl. It should prove the tone and pipeline in one strong vertical slice. Expansion comes after the identity, room-state system, and interaction loop are locked.

04 / Player Promise

You are inside a room that knows the argument better than you do.

You inspect intimate evidence, but every object seems to remember a different version of the relationship.

The threat is not only a double. The threat is that your own memory might be the edited copy.

05 / Game Pillars

Psychological investigation over combat. Player agency comes from reading, comparing, choosing, and surviving emotional contradiction.

Chamber-horror spatial design. Room 14, hallway, office, bathroom, and exterior repeat with specific state changes.

Identity-locked performance. THOREAU, DRYA, and doubles must remain recognizable in gameplay, cinematics, posters, and web.

Playable cinematography. Every capture should feel like a film still, but gameplay must remain readable and controllable.

Expandable multiverse. Game, website, film campaign, fashion, music, and future episodes share structure.

06 / Visual DNA Lock

Category	Rule
Camera	ARRI Alexa 35 / Mini LF feeling, Cooke or Panavision lens language, witness-like framing, no random handheld chaos.
Color	Naturalistic desaturation, green-cyan shadow crush, warm skin preserved, muted olive and distressed brass accents.
Lighting	Tungsten practicals versus sourceless teal, deep negative fill, motivated rim, haze only with purpose.
Texture	Pores, fabric weave, motel dust, worn brass, wet glass, stained carpet, fingerprints, tape wear.
Forbidden	Plastic faces, generic horror blue, superhero gloss, unmotivated neon, gore escalation, asset-pack sameness.

07 / Story Architecture

Premise: Two people argue in a motel room, but the conversation keeps being answered by the wrong double. The player gradually realizes that the room is not replaying the past. It is editing it.

Core tagline: A room for two. A night for four.

Beat	Function	Game Translation
Arrival	Ground the player in Room 14	Key, desk bell, hallway, normal lighting.
Residue	Expose emotional history	Objects unlock conflicting memories.
Mirror Lag	Introduce identity instability	Reflection/event timing contradicts player action.
Tape Contradiction	Show recorded truth as unreliable	Tape playback rewrites room state.
Double Occupancy	Reveal body/voice mismatch	Dark variant appears through posture and timing.
Final Memory Lock	Choose what evidence to believe	End-of-slice title card and web unlock.

08 / Character System

Character	Identity Lock	Playable Function	Drift Risk
THOREAU	Black man, early 30s, medium-deep warm brown skin, round gold glasses, mustache/goatee, guarded intelligent presence.	Player / witness / unreliable memory carrier.	Generic AI face, age shift, missing glasses, incorrect facial hair, over-glamorization.
DRYA	Black woman, late 20s, warm medium-brown skin, dancer body language, jewelry/piercing detail, guarded emotional force.	Relationship anchor / contradiction source / double compare.	Generic glamour model, body-type drift, victim-only staging.
DARK VARIANTS	Same identity, wrong timing, posture, gaze, breath, response delay.	Embodied contradiction.	Monster redesign, gore-first escalation, losing recognizable base identity.

09 / 4-Step 3D Reference Pipeline

This is the locked reference pipeline for every character and complex prop. It prevents bad references from poisoning 3D generation.

Step	Purpose	Do	Do Not	Output
1. Ideation	Lock concept, silhouette, mood.	Generate freely, compare variants, refine identity lock.	Do not ask for T-pose, white background, or orthographic accuracy yet.	Selected concept and identity notes.
2. Clean Sheet	Create modeling reference.	Full body, neutral pose, white/off-white background, neutral light.	Do not use poster lighting or perspective distortion.	Clean full-body sheet.
3. Parts	Protect high-risk details.	Isolate head, glasses, hat, jewelry, hands, coat, props.	Do not redesign parts or change materials.	Part sheets with IDs.
4. Views	Engineer the blueprint.	Front, side, back, optional three-quarter.	Do not change proportions between views.	Orthographic view pack.

10 / Vertical Slice Scope

- One playable character: THOREAU or a temporary proxy until the locked model is ready.

- One main playable location: Room 14 with connected hallway.

- Five inspectable objects: key 14, locket, tape, bathroom mirror, black device.

- Three room states: normal, mirror lag, tape contradiction.

- One double encounter with no combat requirement.

- One web unlock exported from the same narrative data.

- One OVS capture pass: 16:9, 2.39:1, 4:5, and 9:16 crops.

11 / Unreal Technical Architecture

System	Class / File	Responsibility
Interaction	BP_OVS_InteractableBase	Base interaction trace, prompt, and data lookup.
Inspectable	BP_OVS_InspectableObject	Object close-read, rotate, inspect text, evidence unlock.
Room State	BP_OVS_RoomStateController	Lighting, props, audio, triggers, and availability by state.
Mirror Lag	BP_OVS_MirrorLagController	Reflection delay, mismatch cue, state trigger.
Tape	BP_OVS_TapePlayer	Tape UI, playback event, data unlock, room contradiction.
Double	BP_OVS_DoublePresenceActor	Presence cue, blocked path, posture/gaze wrongness.
Save	BP_OVS_SaveState	Evidence, room state, unlocked tapes, player location.
UI	WBP_OVS_InspectUI	Sparse editorial inspect interface.

12 / Folder Architecture

```
OVS_MASTER/
  01_ACTIVE_PROJECTS/
    LIKENESS_THE_GAME/
      unreal/
      web/
      docs/
      data/
      assets/
      exports/
      build_notes/
      agents/
Content/OVS_LIKENESS/
  00_Core/
  01_Characters/
  02_Environments/
  03_Props/
  04_Materials/
  05_Blueprints/
  06_UI/
  07_Audio/
  08_Cinematics/
  09_Data/
  10_Art_Staging/
```

13 / Data Registry Model

Registries are what make the project interchangeable. A character, prop, mechanic, or room can be swapped because every piece has an ID, status, dependency list, and QC note.

Registry	Purpose	Example IDs
asset_manifest.csv	Tracks every prop, mesh, material, audio file, UI asset, source, path, and QC status.	PROP_KEY14_001, PROP_LOCKET_001
character_registry.csv	Tracks identity locks, reference folders, models, and drift notes.	CHR_THOREAU_001, CHR_DRYA_001
mechanics_registry.csv	Tracks mechanics across Unreal and web.	MECH_INSPECT_001, MECH_MIRROR_LAG_001
level_registry.csv	Tracks locations across maps and routes.	LOC_DELLWOOD_ROOM14_001
prompt_registry.csv	Tracks prompt blocks and asset generation sources.	PROMPT_CHR_4STEP_001
narrative_beats.csv	Tracks story beats, triggers, states, and web unlocks.	BEAT_TAPE_CONTRADICTION_001

14 / Phase-by-Phase Build Plan

Phase	Build Action	Acceptance Criteria
0	Preflight repo, Git, docs, registries, Unreal and web foundations.	Project opens, files exist, first commit made.
1	Define vertical slice and lock scope.	One-page slice spec and task board complete.
2	Build Room 14 and hallway greybox.	Player can walk and collide correctly.
3	Implement inspectable object system.	Five objects inspectable from data.
4	Implement room state controller.	Lighting/props/audio change by state.
5	Implement mirror lag prototype.	Event reads clearly and triggers once/reliably.
6	Implement tape contradiction.	Tape unlocks evidence and changes room state.
7	Create character 4-step packs.	THOREAU/DRYA refs pass QC.
8	Import and test assets.	Staged assets logged and material/collision checked.
9	Create Three.js companion alpha.	Routes load and shared JSON is used.
10	Lock vertical slice.	8-12 minute build, QA notes, captures, handoff archive.

15 / Three.js Companion Architecture

The web companion should feel like an extension of the playable motel, not a separate marketing page. It can ship earlier than the game as a public-facing artifact while the Unreal build matures.

Route	Function	Shared Data
/	Landing page with OVS hierarchy and current campaign title.	project metadata, taglines
/motel	Interactive Dellwood map and hidden rooms.	level_registry.csv
/room-14	Micro 3D room with inspectable objects.	asset_manifest.csv, narrative_beats.csv
/tapes	Tape archive and unlock state.	narrative_beats.csv

Route	Function	Shared Data
/characters	Identity cards and doubles.	character_registry.csv
/evidence	Object timeline.	asset_manifest.csv, narrative_beats.csv
/devlog	Production notes.	build_notes

16 / Gaussian Splat Optional Path

Gaussian splats can be useful for captured or generated motel spaces, especially for the web companion or scenic Unreal layers. They should not replace proper collision design. Use the invisible collider mesh for physics and the splat for visuals.

- Unreal path: use a splat renderer such as NanoGS only after testing performance and interaction needs.

- Web path: use Spark.js for Three.js where browser-based splat rooms make sense.

- Collider rule: invisible mesh handles collision and navmesh; splat is paint.

- Trade-off: splats are excellent for photoreal environments, but they are not a full dynamic PBR/Lumen replacement.

17 / Agent Development Handoff

Agents should operate like junior technical artists and engineers inside a constrained production system. They are not allowed to invent the whole project from a vague prompt.

Agent	Best Use	Guardrail
Claude Code	Unreal/editor MCP sessions, repo edits, build tasks, asset organization.	One milestone at a time; require screenshots and build proof.
Codex	Codebase structure, data schemas, web implementation, tests, refactors.	No lore changes without registry updates.
Fable-style web builder	Fast 3D animated website prototype and high-end web motion direction.	Must output editable code/data, not opaque one-off scenes.
Blender MCP Agent	Baking, PBR setup, import/assemble, shader tests, geometry nodes.	Do not reset scenes unless instructed; preserve asset names.

18 / Agent Prompt Block

```
You are the lead technical artist, gameplay engineer, narrative systems designer, and build
producer for LIKENESS : THE GAME, an OVS psychological romantic horror project.  Before
doing anything, read README_START_HERE.md, docs/00_OVS_Production_Workflow.md,
agents/AGENTS.md, and the data registries in /data.  Your job is to build the project in
expandable milestones, not one-off hacks. Preserve the OVS law: Face is the budget. Room is
the antagonist. Camera is a witness. Image must feel playable.  Main deliverables: 1. Unreal
Engine 5.7 vertical slice for Room 14 at The Dellwood motel. 2. Data-driven interaction,
room-state, tape, mirror-lag, evidence, and dialogue systems. 3. Shared JSON/CSV registries
for characters, props, mechanics, levels, narrative beats, and prompts. 4. Three.js
interactive web companion with matching routes, style, objects, and story data. 5. 4-step 3D
character reference workflow for every character: Ideation, Clean Sheet, Parts, Views. 6. QA
reports, screenshot proof, and commits at each stable milestone.  Hard rules: - Do not
delete user files. Archive instead. - Do not rename the folder architecture unless updating
every affected registry and document. - Do not hardcode story text inside Blueprints or
React components. - Do not import assets into final folders until they pass staging QC. - Do
not create 3D characters from loose AI art. Require clean sheets, isolated parts, and views.
- Do not use gore escalation as a shortcut. Doubles are built through posture, timing, gaze,
audio, and memory contradiction. - Do not let the web companion become visually separate
from the Unreal game.  First task: Create or verify the repository structure, initialize
source control, create the Unreal and web app foundations, load the CSV registries, and
produce a TASK_BOARD.md with Milestone 01 through Milestone 10. Then stop and report what
changed, what was created, what still needs human assets, and what exact command/test proves
the build is healthy.
```

19 / QA Gates

Gate	Pass Criteria
Reference QC	Identity, silhouette, accessories, wardrobe, and materials remain locked.
3D QC	Scale, topology, UVs, PBR maps, rig, animations, and export path verified.
Unreal QC	Map opens, player starts, interactions work, room states trigger, save/load stable.
Web QC	Routes load, data loads from JSON, 3D scene performs, mobile layout usable.
Capture QC	Gameplay stills are in-engine, not concept art; crop variants exported.
Handoff QC	Docs, registries, build notes, and task board are updated.

20 / Risk Register

Risk	Prevention
Identity drift	Use locked reference sheets and reject generated faces that miss glasses, facial structure, skin tone, or posture.
Agent sprawl	One milestone per prompt, commit stable states, require proof.
Asset soup	Staging folders, registry IDs, manifest updates.
Blueprint spaghetti	Small classes, data-driven tables, manual graph review, C++ for complex scalable logic.
Website mismatch	Shared data, same palette, same object IDs, same route names.
Overbuilding	Vertical slice before open playground expansion.

21 / Final Deliverables Checklist

- OVS Production Bible PDF complete.

- README_START_HERE.md created.

- docs folder created with workflow and templates.

- agents folder created with AGENTS, CLAUDE, CODEX, FABLE prompt, task board.

- data folder created with CSV registries.

- asset drop folders created.

- Unreal and web structure notes created.

- ZIP package created for agent handoff.

22 / Public and Uploaded Source Notes

The package incorporates the supplied Unreal/Claude workflow notes, the playable Gaussian Splatting article, and the Blender MCP/fal.ai setup notes. Current public checks were used for Unreal Engine 5.7, VibeUE, UnrealClaude, Three.js, Spark.js, and Google AI Studio. Because tool ecosystems change quickly, verify plugin installation instructions again at setup time before entering API keys or installing dependencies.

Source	Use in Pipeline
Uploaded Claude + Unreal transcript	Agent setup, MCP check, Git-first workflow, screenshot proof, milestone commits.
Uploaded Gaussian Splatting article	Optional splat path, collider mesh rule, Spark.js / NanoGS split.
Uploaded Blender MCP article	Blender connector, fal.ai MCP, baking, PBR, 3D asset workflow.
Epic Unreal 5.7 docs	Engine baseline and current release framing.
VibeUE / UnrealClaude public docs	Current agent/editor bridge references.
Three.js / Spark.js docs	Web companion and splat renderer direction.